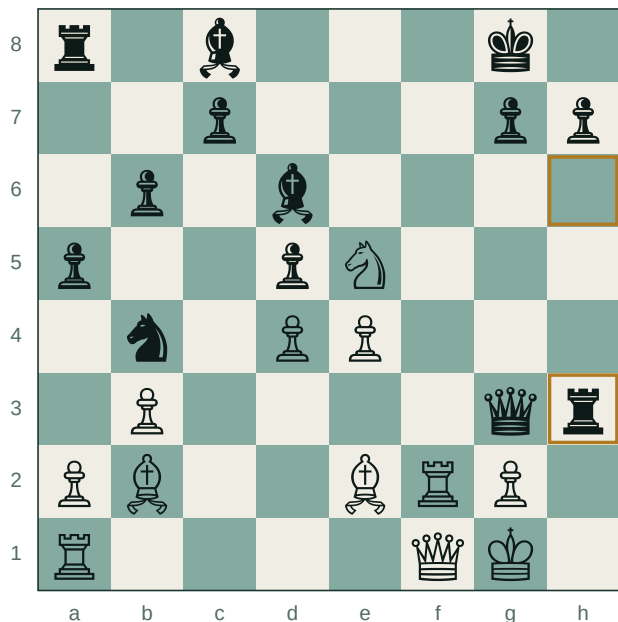


Clearance tactics: White, move 22

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 21...Rxh3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

22. Rf8+ Bxf8 23. Qf7+ Kh8 24. Qxf8#

22.Rf8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f8 it attacks king on g8 and bishop on c8. Recorded reply: **22...Bxf8**.

23.Qf7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f7 it attacks king on g8 and bishop on f8. Recorded reply: **23...Kh8**.

24.Qxf8# Mate: queen on f8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on f8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.